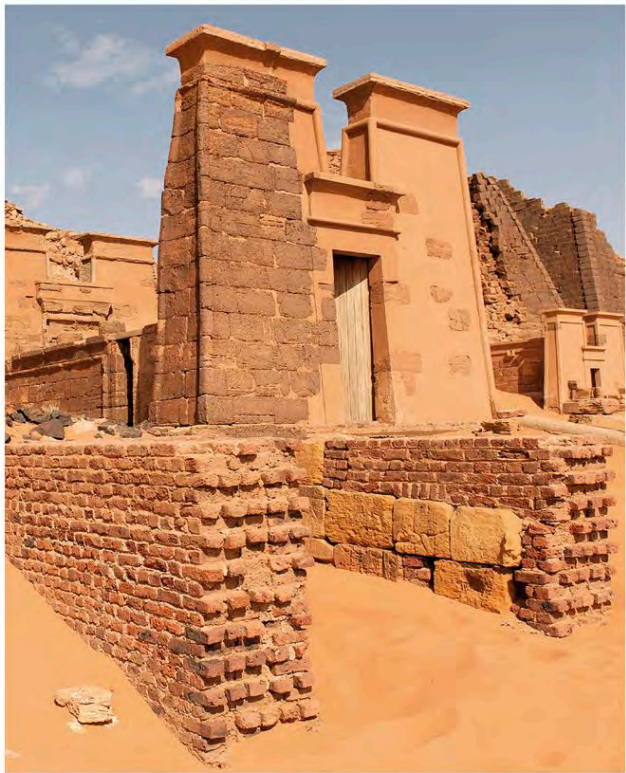
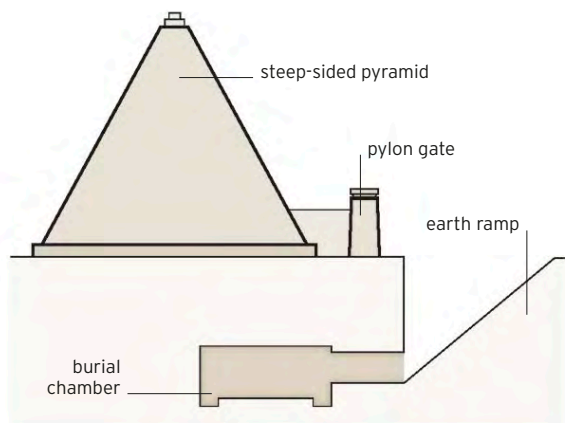


PYRAMID DESIGN

The pyramids at Meroë are in the typically Nubian style, smaller and steeper than those found in Egypt. They are constructed from blocks of sandstone, rising at an angle of 60-73 degrees from a narrow base to a height of between 20 ft (6 m) and 98 ft (30 m). Entrance to each pyramid is through a covered passage behind a monumental gateway, but the burial chambers are dug separately into the ground at the foot of an earth ramp.



△ ENTRANCE PASSAGEWAY

A covered stone passageway of relatively simple rectilinear design leads from the entrance to the interior of each pyramid.

◁ PYLON GATEWAY

A feature of the Meroë pyramids is the monumental gateway, modeled on Egyptian temple gates known as pylons, which leads to the entrance passageway.

